

Chap 3: FREEDOM OF SPEECH

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Communications Paradigms

Communications Paradigms

- A **communications paradigm** refers to the model or structure through which information is created, transmitted, and received.

In CS & IT:

- **One-to-Many Model:** Traditional media websites (e.g., news portals).
- **Many-to-Many Model:** Social media platforms, discussion forums, GitHub collaboration.
- **Client-Server Model:** Web applications where users request services from servers.
- **Peer-to-Peer (P2P):** File-sharing networks like BitTorrent.

Example:

- A cloud-based messaging app like WhatsApp uses a **client-server paradigm**, while blockchain networks use a **decentralized paradigm**.

Regulating Communications Media

Regulating Communications Media

- o Governments regulate digital communication to prevent misuse such as cybercrime, misinformation, or hate speech.

In IT Context:

- o Internet governance laws
- o Data protection regulations (e.g., GDPR-like laws)
- o Telecom regulations
- o Platform moderation policies

Example:

- o A government may require social media platforms to remove extremist content within 24 hours.

Free Speech Principles

Free Speech Principles

- o Free speech allows individuals to express opinions without government interference, but it is not absolute.

In CS & IT:

- o Social media posts
- o Blogging platforms
- o Online forums
- o YouTube content creation

Example:

- o A developer criticizing a software company on a tech blog is exercising free speech.

Controlling Speech

Controlling Speech

- o Speech may be controlled when it:
- o Incites violence
- o Promotes terrorism
- o Spreads harmful misinformation
- o Violates privacy

IT Example:

- o A platform using AI algorithms to remove hate speech or fake news.

Offensive Speech: What Is It? What Is Illegal? Censorship Laws and Alternatives

Offensive Speech:

- o Speech that is insulting, abusive, or disturbing but not necessarily illegal.

Illegal Speech:

- o Hate speech
- o Threats
- o Defamation
- o Incitement to violence

IT Example:

- o Posting abusive comments on social media.
- o Spreading false allegations about a company (defamation).

Alternatives to Censorship:

- o Content moderation
- o Community guidelines
- o User reporting systems
- o Warning labels

Child Pornography and Sexting

Child Pornography and Sexting

- o This is strictly illegal in most countries.

In IT Context:

- o Sharing explicit images of minors via messaging apps
- o Cloud storage misuse
- o Dark web distribution

CS Role:

- o AI detection tools to detect illegal content
- o Reporting mechanisms
- o Encryption challenges

Example:

- o Social media platforms using machine learning to detect and remove illegal images.

Spam

Spam

- o Spam refers to unwanted or unsolicited digital messages.

In IT:

- o Email spam
- o SMS spam
- o Bot-generated comments
- o Phishing emails

Example:

- o Receiving fake job offers asking for personal data.

IT Solution:

- o Spam filters
- o Machine learning classifiers
- o CAPTCHA systems

Challenging Old Regulatory Structures and Special Interests

Challenging Old Regulatory Structures and Special Interests

- o Digital technology challenges traditional laws.

Example:

- o Ride-sharing apps challenging taxi regulations.
- o Cryptocurrency challenging banking systems.
- o Online streaming challenging broadcast regulations.

IT Impact:

- o Governments struggle to update outdated laws for digital platforms.

Posting, Selling, and Leaking Sensitive Material

Posting, Selling, and Leaking Sensitive Material

Sensitive material includes:

- o Personal data
- o Company trade secrets
- o Government classified data

IT Examples:

- o Data breaches
- o Hackers leaking databases
- o Insider selling customer data
- o Whistleblowers publishing confidential documents

Ethical Issue:

- o Balance between public interest and privacy/security.

Anonymity

Anonymity

- o Anonymity allows users to hide their identity online.

Benefits:

- o Protects whistleblowers
- o Encourages free expression
- o Protects political activists

Risks:

- o Cyberbullying
- o Online harassment
- o Dark web criminal activity

IT Example:

- o Anonymous browsing via Tor
- o Fake social media accounts